

LINUX & GIT — QUICK CHEAT SHEET

Online Activity #2 | Kenneth Quizan | Simple Reference

1. BASIC LINUX COMMANDS	
pwd	pwd Prints the directory I am currently in.
ls	ls -la Lists files and folders, including hidden ones. Flags: -l details; -a all
cd	cd Documents Moves to another directory. Flags: .. parent; ~ home
mkdir	mkdir -p project/src Creates a new folder. Flags: -p creates parents
touch	touch notes.txt Creates a file if it does not exist.
cp	cp file.txt backup/ Copies a file or folder. Flags: -r recursive; -i prompt
mv	mv old.txt new.txt Moves or renames a file. Flags: -i prompt
rm	rm -i notes.txt Removes a file. Flags: -i prompt; -r recursive
cat	cat README.md Displays a file's contents. Flags: -n number lines
grep	grep -n "error" log.txt Finds matching text in a file. Flags: -n line number; -i ignore case
head / tail	head -n 5 file.txt Shows the start / end of a file. Flags: -n line count; -f follow
chmod	chmod +x script.sh Changes file permissions. Flags: +x add execute permission

2. BASIC GIT COMMANDS	
git init	git init Creates a new local Git repository. Flags: -b initial branch
git restore	git restore --staged file.txt Unstages a file or restores file contents. Flags: --staged unstage; --source=
git status	git status -sb Shows branch and file changes. Flags: -s short; -b branch info
git branch	git branch feature Lists or creates branches. Flags: -a all; -d delete; -m rename
git add	git add . Stages changes for the next commit. Flags: . current tree; -A all
git switch / checkout	git switch -c feature Changes branches; switch is the modern choice. Flags: -c create + switch
git commit	git commit -m "Update" Saves staged changes as a new snapshot. Flags: -m message; -a tracked edits
git merge	git merge feature Combines another branch into the current branch. Flags: --no-ff; --abort
git log	git log --oneline Displays commit history. Flags: --oneline compact; --graph
git tag	git tag v1.0 Names a specific commit, often a release. Flags: -a annotated; -d delete
git diff	git diff --staged Shows differences between versions/states. Flags: --staged; --stat
git clone	git clone Downloads an existing repository. Flags: -b branch; --depth 1 shallow

3. GIT THREE-TREE ARCHITECTURE		
WORKING DIRECTORY	STAGING AREA / INDEX	REPOSITORY
Files I am editing right now. Use: git add	Changes selected for the next commit. Check: git diff --staged	Permanent committed snapshots in .git . Create: git commit
Simple workflow: edit → git status → git add → git diff --staged → git commit → git log		

References: Git Documentation — git-scm.com/docs; Pro Git Book — git-scm.com/book/en/v2; GNU Coreutils Manual — gnu.org/software/coreutils/manual/. Accessed September 17, 2026. Descriptions are paraphrased.